PP-T-1823C
May 27, 1981
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. PP-T-1823B
May 1, 1978

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TURKEY, BONELESS, FROZEN, RAW OR COOKED

This specification was approved by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, for use by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for turkey, boneless, frozen, raw or cooked.

1.2 Classification. Boneless, frozen, raw or cooked turkey shall be of the following types, classes and styles, as specified (see 6.1):

Types:

I - Raw, molded (with skin covering - see items 4 and 5, table IV)

II - Raw roll
- Style A - Tied (with skin covering)
- Style B - Netted (with skin covering)
- Style C - Shrink bag (without skin covering)
- Style D - Bag, tightly adhering to roll (without skin covering)

III - Cooked, encased (without skin covering)

IV - Cooked, encased (without skin covering; with added isolated soy protein)

V - Cooked, encased (without skin covering, with added isolated soy protein, with iodized salt). Not for Military procurement

Condition:

A - With seasoning and salt
B - Without seasoning and salt

Classes:

1 - Produced subsequent to award of contract (see 3.4.1)
2 - Commercial product produced under continuous supervision (see 3.4.2)

FSC 8905

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin-Gauge, Polyolefin
EE-S-631	-	Spices, Ground and Whole and Spice Blends
QQ-A-1876	-	Aluminum Foil
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	-	Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Washington, DC; Philadelphia; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-C-43619	-	Cloth, Netting, Cotton, Elasticized, Raschel Knit

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Agriculture

Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto (7 CFR 2870)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Poultry and Dairy Quality Division, Food Safety and Quality Service, Washington, DC 20250.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR 381)

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act (21 CFR) and regulations promulgated thereunder

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Research Council

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of the Director, National Academy of Sciences, National Research Council, 2101 Constitution Ave., N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. All ingredients and materials shall be free from foreign material, foreign odor and foreign color. Component materials for class 1 product shall comply with table I.

TABLE I. Component materials (class 1)

Item	Requirement
(1)	Turkeys
	(a) Fresh chilled or frozen (frozen less than 180 days). For condition B only, when specified (see 6.1), fresh chilled whole bodied birds.
	(b) Young tom or hen turkeys (usually under 8 months age) of USDA Grade B or better or US Procurement Grade I or better, as defined in the Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto (7CFR 2870). For condition B only, the finished product shall be produced from US Grade A or B whole birds. Excluded from condition B shall be wing tips, drumsticks, giblets, necks, backs, and boney material.
(2)	Salt
	Salt shall be white refined non-iodized sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agent. For type V salt shall be white refined iodized sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Component materials (class 1) (cont'd)

Item	Requirement
(3)	Pepper Shall be ground, white or black pepper complying with type II of EE-S-631.
(4)	Phosphate Any of the phosphates listed in the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations shall be acceptable for this product.
	Optional ingredient:
(5)	Monosodium glutamate shall be free flowing, granules or crystals and shall be transparent and colorless. It shall conform to the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2 Processing. Class 1 product shall be processed in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Processing requirements

Item	Requirement
(1)	The following formulas shall be used: 1/

Condition A

Ingredients	Types I and II 2/	Type III	Type IV	Type V
	Percent	Percent	Percent	Percent
Turkey meat	98.98 4/	88.07 4/	78.68 4/	78.68 4/
Salt	0.99	0.82	0.79	0.79 (iodized)
Pepper, black	0.03	0.04	0.02	0.02
Skin, raw, finely chopped		10.57 5/	13.57 5/	13.57 5/
Phosphate (sodium salt - see table I, item 4)		0.50 3/	0.45 3/	0.45 3/
Isolated soy protein			1.57 6/	1.57 6/
Water			4.92	4.92

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Processing requirements (cont'd)

Item	Requirement	
	Condition B	
Ingredients	Types I and II 2/	Type III
	Percent	Percent
Turkey meat	100.00	89.29
Skin, raw, finely ground	-	10.71

(2) Fabrication requirements:

(a) All types shall be free from pin feathers, blood clots and bruises, bone or hard tendons measuring over 1/4 inch (6 mm) or greater in any dimension, and large blood vessels.

(b) During the emulsification of the skin, the temperature of the skin shall not exceed 45°F (7°C). Dry ice may be used in an amount not exceeding that required to effect temperature control.

(c) The ingredients shall be uniformly distributed on the surfaces of the meat during fabrication.

(d) For types I, II, and III, the meat required shall have at least 50 percent, by weight, of white meat and not less than 80 percent of the meat required shall be whole or halved breasts and thighs. For types IV and V, the percent of white meat shall be 43.27 percent (minimum) and the percent of dark meat shall be 35.41 percent (maximum). The meat for types IV and V shall not be ground through plates with holes smaller than 1-1/2 inches (38 mm).

(e) For types I, II, and III, the product shall be arranged so that the breast meat is opposite the thigh meat or in alternate layers of dark and light meat.

(f) For types I and II, the product shall contain no ground, comminuted or mechanically deboned meat.

(3) Cooking requirements. Types III, IV and V shall be cooked in a water bath or in an oven in a steam or high humidity atmosphere to an internal temperature of not more than 175°F (79°C) nor less than 160°F (71°C) in the thickest part of the product. The water bath or oven shall not exceed 190°F (88°C).

1/ Monosodium glutamate may be used in the formulations for Condition A products in accordance with commercial practice. Monosodium glutamate shall be excluded from Condition B products.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2/ See also the skin covering requirements of table IV and classification of types.

3/ Phosphates for types III, IV and V may be added to the turkey meat and other ingredients as a slurry. The slurry shall be composed of not more than four parts of water to one part of phosphate.

4/ Trim meat may be used but shall not exceed 10 percent (by weight) of the total white and dark meat requirement and shall be included as part of the total allowable white and dark meat. Trim meat shall be the small pieces of white and dark meat remaining from normal deboning of the carcass. Dark meat left over from the thighs during fabrication of other turkey products is considered trim meat. The trim meat shall be held at 40°F (4°C) or lower but not frozen and shall be used within 36 hours after removal from the carcass.

5/ For types III, IV and V, mechanically deboned turkey meat may be substituted in part for the skin but shall not exceed 8 percent of the total weight of the meat and skin. Neck skin, if used, shall be trimmed of excess fat and membranes as well as discoloration and hair. The wing and drumstick meat may or may not be used.

6/ At the option of the contractor 2.36 percent soy protein concentrate and 4.13 percent water may be substituted for the requirements of 1.57 percent isolated soy protein and 4.92 percent water.

3.3 Finished products. Class 1 products (all types) shall comply with tables III and IV, as applicable.

TABLE III. Finished product requirements

Item	Requirement
(1)	The thickness of skin and fat combined shall not exceed 1/4-inch (6 mm) at any point (types I and II).
(2)	There shall be no loose pieces (tag ends) of skin, muscle tissue, fat and casing or string which extends more than 1/2-inch (13 mm) from the surface of any unit.
(3)	There shall be no soft spots. 1/
(4)	The product shall be preserved in accordance with 5.1.1.1, 5.1.1.2 or 5.1.1.3, as applicable.
(5)	The boneless turkey, after being properly unit packed or wrapped, shall be placed in a blast/quick freezer within 4 hours after processing, and frozen to a temperature of 0°F (-18°C) in the thickest part of the product within 36 hours from the completion of processing. After being frozen and until time of delivery, the temperature shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C) in the thickest part of the product. The product shall remain in a sound, wholesome condition in a hard frozen state, and the temperature shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C) in the thickest part of the product at destination. The product shall show no evidence of defrosting or refreezing.
(6)	The product shall be in sound, wholesome condition with no evidence of off-condition such as off-color, slightly sticky, etc.

1/ Soft spots may be caused by some folding and pocketing throughout the roll. When these voids or pockets occur near the surface, they produce a soft spot.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Additional finished product requirements

Item	Requirement
	Type I
(1)	Shall be 9 to 15 inches (229 to 381 mm) in length.
(2)	The height, width or diameter of the formed product shall be no less than 3-1/2 inches (89 mm) and no greater than 5 inches (127 mm).
(3)	Shall weigh not more than 14 nor less than 9 pounds (4.1 to 6.4 kg).
(4)	Skin shall cover the outer surface of the product smoothly and tightly to avoid wrinkling, folding and pocketing. The product shall not have more than two areas not covered by skin; the total uncovered areas shall be not more than 2 square inches (1290 mm^2).
(5)	The skin may overlap but shall not overlap more than 3 inches (76 mm) at any point for the entire length of one side of the block. (NOTE: When soft spots are found under such overlap, such defects shall be tallied in accordance with item 3, table III).
	Type II
(6)	Shall be 9 to 17 inches (229 to 432 mm) in length.
(7)	Shall be 4 to 7 inches (102 to 178 mm) in diameter.
(8)	Shall weigh not more than 14 nor less than 9 pounds (4.1 to 6.4 kg).
(9)	The skin shall cover the entire product as completely as possible and in no case shall the skin covering be less than 75 percent of the total exposed surface area for style A and B only.
(10)	Turkey rolls shall be secured by one of the following methods to make a compact, intact, firmly secured roll: (a) Style A shall have been tied with cotton twine at intervals of not more than 3 inches (76 mm) nor less than 2 inches (51 mm) apart around the circumference from one end to the other. (b) Style B shall be completely inclosed in elasticized netting material meeting the requirements of MIL-C-43619. (c) Style C shall be completely inclosed in a bag made of a film meeting the requirements of 5.1.1.2.1 (b). (d) Style D shall be completely enclosed in a tightly adhering bag made of the material specified in 5.1.1.2.1 (e).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Additional finished product requirements (cont'd)

Item	Requirement
	Type III
(11)	Shall be 4-1/2 to 5 inches (114 to 127 mm) in diameter.
(12)	Shall weigh not less than 9 pounds, 8 ounces (4.3 kg) nor more than 10 pounds, 8 ounces (4.8 kg).
(13)	The casing shall be tightened after drainage to encompass the meat to the full diameter, leaving the casing free of wrinkles. Blow holes not to exceed 1/64 inch in diameter (nominal dimension) (0.40 mm) may be put into the casing to facilitate the removal of entrapped air and excess broth. These blow holes shall not be classified as a defect. 1/
(14)	The product shall remain intact when sliced 1/8 inch (3 mm) thick while cold (40°F ± 5°F) (4°C ± 3°C).
	Types IV and V
(15)	Shall be 4-1/2 to 5 inches (114 to 127 mm) in diameter.
(16)	Shall weigh not less than 9 pounds, 8 ounces (4.3 kg) nor more than 10 pounds, 8 ounces (4.8 kg).
(17)	After cooking, the casing shall be tight fitting and not sag or wrinkle.
(18)	The product shall remain intact when sliced 1/8 inch (3 mm) thick while cold (35°F to 45°F) (2°C to 7°C).

1/ Wrinkles at each end of the casing, but not extending beyond the curve of the end of the roll, shall not be classified as defects.

3.4 Description of classes.

3.4.1 Class 1. Class 1 product shall meet the applicable type and style requirement of this specification and shall be produced under continuous supervision of a representative of the USDA, Food Safety and Quality Service subsequent to award of contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.4.2. Class 2. The class 2 product shall be made in accordance with commercial practice, produced and delivered under the provisions of 3.5 and 3.6. The product shall be processed without binders or broth. The product shall be processed from whole birds. In addition, dark meat and skin shall not be used in amounts greater than they appear in their natural proportion to the whole carcass. The product shall contain no ground, finely chopped or comminuted meat. Skin shall be finely ground. For Military agencies only, the age of the class 2 product from time of manufacture to time of offer shall not exceed 60 days. The product shall be produced under the continuous supervision of a representative of the Poultry and Dairy Quality Division, FSQS, USDA.

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act (21 CFR). All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product and the turkey used in the preparation of the product shall be processed in a plant operating under the continuous supervision of the Food Safety and Quality Service, USDA, and shall be inspected, passed and marked in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Plant qualification. The product shall be unacceptable if produced and stored in plants not meeting the requirements specified in 3.6.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1. Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1.1. Examination of turkeys. Determination of compliance with the requirements of table I shall be based upon a review of USDA grade and identity markings on individual turkeys or boxes or a USDA grade certificate. In addition, when frozen turkeys are used, a review of storage records and markings on the boxes shall be used to determine compliance with the storage limitation requirements. Nonconformance to the above referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of turkeys or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.1.2 Examination of salt, monosodium glutamate and phosphate. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the condition requirements of 3.1. The sample for examination shall be a 1-pound (0.45 kg) composite derived from five primary containers or from all containers if less than five form a lot. In addition, examination shall be made to determine compliance with the identity requirements of items 2, 4, and 5 of table I. Nonconformance to the condition or identity requirements referenced above reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.3.1.3 Examination of pepper. Examination of pepper shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of EE-S-631 relating to the product characteristics and sieve size, except that the sample for examination shall be a 100-gram composite derived from five primary containers or all containers if less than five form a lot. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.1.4 Component testing. In addition to any testing required in 4.3.1, components shall be tested as shown in table V. Results shall be applicable to the lot average. Nonconformance to one or more test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the applicable lot. The inspection level for determining sample size shall be S-1.

TABLE V. Component tests

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Characteristic	Results reported to	Test ref and rqmt para
Aluminum foil	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	5.1.1.1 1/ 4.4.2
Vinyl or vinyl copolymer base plastic	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Basis weight	Pound per ream (g/m^2)	5.1.1.1 5.1.1.1.1
Bag materials:					
(a) Copolymer vinylidene chloride with vinyl chloride	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.1.1.2.1 (a) 1/ 4.4.3

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Component tests (cont'd)

Component	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Characteristic	Results reported to	Test ref and rqmt para
Bag materials: (cont'd)					
(b) Polyethylene terephthalate	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm)	5.1.1.2.1 (b) 1/ 4.4.3
(c) Polyvinyl chloride	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch 0.01 mm)	5.1.1.2.1 (c) 1/ 4.4.3
(d) Polyethylene	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	5.1.1.2.1 (d) 4.4.3 1/
(e) Polypropylene	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	5.1.1.2.1 (e) 1/ 4.4.3
Casing (a) Regenerative cellulose	One casing	Casing	Moisture imperveability	Pass or fail	5.1.1.3 4.4.1
(b) Polyester	One casing	Casing	Thickness	Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm)	5.1.1.3 4.4.3 1/
Wrapper polyethylene	1/2 yard (0.5 m) or one sheet	Yards or sheets	Thickness	Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm)	5.2.1.1 (a) 4.4.3 1/

1/ In lieu of testing the thickness of each laminae, determination of compliance to thickness requirements may be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. Nonconformance to thickness requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.1.5 Certification. When specified in the contract (see 6.1), the contractors shall furnish an official grading certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Agriculture certifying that the grade of product supplied is as required by the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.2 In-process inspection. Examination shall be made during processing to determine compliance with the requirements of table II and 3.4.2. In addition, records of formulation, time and temperature shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable.

4.3.3 End item inspection. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables VII and VIII. The examination criteria for the above referenced tables shall be as shown in table VI. AQLs shall be expressed as defects per hundred units.

TABLE VI. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQL Major A	AQL Major B	AQL Minor
VII	S-3	One unit pack	Unit packs		2.5	6.5
VIII	S-2	One unit pack	Unit packs	1/	1.5	6.5

1/ Finding of one or more Major A defects shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE VII. Examination of unit packing

Category		Defect
Major B	Minor	
	201	Wrapper not colored as specified
	202	Not wrapped as specified
151		Bag not closed or not closed as specified
152		Bag does not cling tightly to the product
	203	Bag size not as specified
	204	Casing not size specified
153		Unclean
154		Hole or tear
155		Not specified unit packing material

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

TABLE VIII. Examination of product characteristics

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	All types
101			Presence of foreign material such as paint, glass, wood, etc.
102			Presence of foreign color or odor
103			Presence of off-condition, i.e., slightly sticky, etc.
	151		Presence of loose pieces (tag ends) of skin, muscle tissue, or fat extending more than 1/2-inch (13 mm) from the surface of any unit
			Type I
		201	Length less than 9 inches (229 mm) or more than 15 inches (381 mm) 1/
		202	Height, width or diameter of form product less than 3-1/2 inches (89 mm) or more than 5 inches (127 mm) 2/
		203	Weight more than 14 pounds (6.4 kg) or less than 9 pounds (4.1 kg) 4/
		204	Total uncovered areas exceed 2 square inches (1290 mm^2)
		205	Skin overlap more than 3 inches (76 mm) at any point for the entire length of one side of the block 1/
		206	Thickness of skin and fat combined exceeds 1/4 inch (6 mm) at any point
			Type II
		207	Length less than 9 inches (229 mm) or more than 17 inches (432 mm) 1/
		208	Diameter less than 4 inches (102 mm) or more than 7 inches (178 mm) 1/
		209	Weight more than 14 pounds (6.4 kg) or less than 9 pounds (4.1 kg) 4/
	152		Skin covering less than 75 percent of the surface area 3/
	153		Not a compact, intact or firmly secured roll
	154		Not tied
		210	String intervals more than 3 inches (76 mm) or less than 2 inches (51 mm) 1/
		211	Thickness of skin and fat combined exceeds 1/4 inch (6 mm) at any point
		212	Presence of soft spots

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VIII. Examination of product characteristics (cont'd)

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	Type III
		213	Diameter less than 4-1/2 inches (114 mm) or more than 5 inches (127 mm)
		214	Weight less than 9 pounds, 8 ounces (4.3 kg) or more than 10 pounds, 8 ounces (4.8 kg)
		215	Casing not free of wrinkles
	155		Product does not remain intact when sliced 1/8 inch (3 mm) thick 5/ while cold 40° ± 5°F (4° ± 3°C) 6/
			Types IV and V
		216	Diameter less than 4-1/2 inches (114 mm) or more than 5 inches (127 mm)
		217	Weight less than 9 pounds, 8 ounces (4.3 kg) or more than 10 pounds, 8 ounces (4.8 kg)
		218	Casing sags or is not free of wrinkles
	156		Product does not remain intact when sliced 1/8 inch thick (3 mm) 5/ while cold 35° to 45°F (2° to 7°C) 6/

1/ Measure to nearest 1/2 inch (millimeter).

2/ Measure to nearest 1/8 inch (millimeter).

3/ Measure to nearest 5 percent.

4/ Weigh to nearest 1/2 pound (0.1 kg).

5/ Measure to nearest 1/16 inch (millimeter).

6/ Measure to nearest whole degree.

4.3.3.1 Examination of class 2 product for identity, condition, preservation, packing and marking. Conformance of class 2 product to the identity requirements of 3.4.2 shall be determined by examination of the USDA inspection legend, pertinent labels, invoices or other valid documents. In addition, the product shall be examined for compliance with the condition, preservation, packing and marking requirements referenced in 3.4.2, 3.5, 3.6 and 5.1 through 5.3. The sample unit for examination shall be one primary container. Five such containers shall be examined from each lot. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot of finished product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.3.2 Examination of elasticized netting material. Examination of elasticized netting material shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-C-43619.

4.3.4 Packaging inspection.

4.3.4.1 Examination of the filled and closed shipping container. Examination of the filled and closed shipping container for level B pack shall be in accordance with the examination criteria contained in the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination. Major: (1) NSN, contract no., date of pack, or item description markings: missing, incorrect or illegible (Military Agencies only). (2) Markings: missing, incorrect or illegible (Civil Agencies only.) Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible (Military Agencies only). (2) Type I product not separated as specified in 5.2.1.1 (a) or (b). (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. (4) More than specified weight as indicated by marked net weight. Level C containers shall be examined for the marking defects specified and for the closure specified in 5.2.2.

4.3.4.2 Examination for net weight. The shipping containers shall be examined for the average weight of product contained therein. The sample unit shall be one filled shipping container. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The inspection level shall be S-4. The lot shall be rejected if the average net weight of the sample is less than the average of the net weights marked on the shipping containers in the sample.

4.3.4.3 Examination for temperature after processing, during storage, at time of delivery and at destination. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of item 5, table III. Records of time and temperature shall be as concerns placing of product in freezer, and the time to reduce temperature to 0°F (-18°C). Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the lot. In addition, examination shall be made at time of shipment or delivery to determine compliance with item 5, table III. Lot size shall be expressed in containers. The sample unit shall be one container. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. The AQL expressed as percent defective shall be 2.5 expressed as a major defective. Further evidence of defrosting shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Methods of inspection.

4.4.1 Moisture impermeability test. Moisture impermeability test shall be performed as follows: Place a section of the casing, exterior side up, on a piece of absorbent paper. Pour a small pool of water 60° to 80°F (16° to 27°C) on the center of the test material and let stand for 15 minutes. Examine absorbent paper for damp spots. Absence of moist spots will indicate a moisture impermeable casing material.

4.4.2 Thickness of aluminum foil. Thickness of aluminum foil shall be determined in accordance with the procedure specified in QQ-A-1876.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 Bag materials. Thickness of bag materials shall be determined in accordance with L-P-378.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level B.

5.1.1 Level B. The product shall be unit packed in accordance with 5.1.1.1, 5.1.1.2, or 5.1.1.3, as applicable.

5.1.1.1 Type I. The product, as specified in 3.3, shall be tightly wrapped in a sheet of aluminum foil (coated side towards the product) of sufficient size to cover the block completely. The aluminum foil shall be 0.002-inch (0.05 mm) thick (see 4.4.2), and shall be coated on one side with not less than 3 pounds per ream (24 by 36 - 480) (5 g/m^2) of a vinyl or vinyl copolymer base plastic coating conforming to 5.1.1.1.1. The coating shall be colored with a nontoxic coloring material to facilitate identification of the coated side. The aluminum foil may be embossed to insure dead-fold characteristics. The long end of the wrapper shall be brought face to face and closed by means of a confectioner's fold. The ends of the wrapper shall be folded tightly against the product.

5.1.1.1.1 The vinyl coating shall:

(a) Impart no odor, flavor or color to the product.

(b) Have a composition which has been approved for contact with food products by the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(c) Be satisfactory in resisting oven baking temperature of approximately 450°F (232°C) for 30 minutes.

5.1.1.2 Type II. Styles A and B product, as specified in 3.3, shall be inserted into a bag constructed from one of the materials specified in 5.1.1.2.1. The bag shall be closed with a malleable metal clip, or other equivalent method. The bag shall cling tightly to the product as the result of shrinking, vacuumizing or mechanical means, or a combination of two or more of these methods. The bag shall be of sufficient diameter and length to result in a product complying with the applicable size requirements specified in 3.3. Style C product shall be inclosed in the material specified in 5.1.1.2.1 (b) or (e).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.2.1 Bag materials. Bags shall be constructed from one of the following materials:

(a) Frozen food grade film formed by copolymerizing vinylidene chloride with vinyl chloride. The film shall average not less than 0.0015-inch (0.038 mm) thick.

(b) A shrinkable polyethylene terephthalate film .00065-inch (0.0165 mm) nominal thickness.

(c) Polyvinyl chloride with suitable food grade plasticizers not less than 0.002-inch (0.05 mm) thick.

(d) A shrinkable polyethylene 0.001-inch (0.03 mm) thick.

(e) Polypropylene, white opaque, duplexed multi-ply with inner ply treated for meat adhesion. Ninety-gauge double wound with a total minimum thickness of 0.0018 inch (0.046 mm).

5.1.1.3 Types III, IV and V. Types III, IV and V products, as specified in 3.3, shall be stuffed or pumped into a regenerated cellulose casing, with reinforcing cellulosic fibers, coated with plastic material to make the casing moisture impermeable or encased in the material specified in 5.1.1.2.1(e). Alternatively, a seamless casing may be used which shall be constructed from shrinkable food grade polyester film not less than 0.001-inch (0.03 mm) thick. The moisture impermeability shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1. The diameter and length of the casings shall be sufficient to comply with 3.3. The ends of the casing shall be secured as specified in 5.1.1.2.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B. Not more than 56 pounds (25 kg) of the product shall be packed into a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style FTC, V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated, fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of the wax-impregnated box shall be made with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black.

5.2.1.1 Type I only. The wrapped blocks of turkey shall be separated from each other by one of the following methods in such a manner that there shall be no foil-to-foil contact between the individual units:

(a) Each wrapped block of turkey shall be inclosed in a bag constructed of polyethylene 0.0015-inch (0.038 mm) thick.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(b) The wrapped blocks shall be separated by a one-piece divider scored and folded so as to partially inclose and completely separate the individual blocks. The divider shall be made of the same material as the shipping container.

5.2.1.2 Alternate shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3.1), the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated, fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of the wax-impregnated box shall be made with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable except that the closure of fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Wrappers and casings. Labeling shall conform to the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations. For type I product, the following information shall be included in the labeling:

REMOVE POLY BAG

TURKEY SHOULD BE COOKED IN FOIL WRAPPER

For type II, style C product, the following information shall be included in the labeling:

DO NOT REMOVE BAG BEFORE COOKING

5.3.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 for Military agencies and in accordance with FED-STD-123 for Civil agencies. In addition, the following precautionary marking shall appear on top of the shipping container in letters between 1 inch (25 mm) and 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) high, all letters being of the same height:

KEEP FROZEN

0°F (-18°C) OR BELOW

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style (for type II), and condition of product required (see 1.2).
(c) When fresh chilled whole bodied birds are required for Condition B product (see 3.1).
(d) When a USDA grading certificate is required (see 4.3.1.5).
(e) Level of packing required (see 5.2).
(f) When packing specified in 5.2.1.2 is required.

6.2 Destination inspection (Civil agencies). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.3 Military agencies. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/ AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3.1 Alternate shipping containers. The alternate shipping containers specified in 5.2.1.2 may be used when experience or knowledge of the destination and mode of shipment indicates that a lower grade of fiberboard may be used.

6.4 Award of contract. Award of contract for the product specified in this specification shall be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.6 (also see 4.2).

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP- SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

USDA - FSQS, FQAD
VA - DMS

Project No. 8905-0942

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.